# Mario Vicuña

**Senior WordPress Developer | Custom Plugins (PHP), Elementor Pro, Local SEO**

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Web developer with 9+ years in ecommerce and 50+ Shopify and WordPress stores built. I design, build, host and maintain WordPress sites for small businesses, from Elementor Pro, Divi, WPBakery and BeTheme sites to a custom PHP plugin that runs a studio's bookings, students and payments behind a private portal, on servers I set up on AWS. I care about speed, local SEO and handing over sites the owner can edit. I use Claude Code and Codex daily, with Git, release checks and tests to keep quality high. Open to full-time and part-time remote roles and freelance projects.

## CORE SKILLS

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|---|---|
| **WordPress** | Custom plugins in PHP (custom tables with $wpdb, roles and capabilities, WP-Cron, admin screens), child themes, Contact Form 7 |
| **Page builders and themes** | Elementor Pro (incl. custom dynamic tags), Divi, WPBakery, BeTheme, Hello Elementor |
| **Hosting and servers** | AWS (Lightsail, Route 53, SES, IAM, Budgets), Ubuntu Linux, Nginx (FastCGI cache, security headers), PHP-FPM, MariaDB, WP-CLI, Let's Encrypt, fail2ban, Bash, hosting migrations |
| **SEO and analytics** | Rank Math, Yoast SEO, structured data, local SEO, Google Site Kit (GA4, Search Console) |
| **Security** | Nonces, capability checks, sanitization and escaping, prepared queries, encryption with libsodium |
| **Front end** | JavaScript, CSS, PWA, responsive and mobile-first, accessibility (WCAG 2.2) |
| **Performance and growth** | Core Web Vitals, A/B testing, conversion-focused landing pages |
| **Also** | Shopify and Shopify Plus, Magento to Shopify migrations |
| **Tools** | Git, GitHub Actions, LocalWP, Claude Code, Codex |

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Freelance Shopify & WordPress Developer, Vicunav**

June 2026 to Present | Remote

- Designed, built, wrote the copy for and maintain three live sites for local businesses: tatipilates.com and bhoga.yoga (Elementor Pro on Hello Elementor) and nelsonlookflash.com (WPBakery).
- Built a private WordPress plugin (16,000+ lines of PHP, 7 custom tables) that runs the Tati Pilates studio: schedules and spots, students on native WordPress accounts, weekly and individual plans, bookings, makeup sessions, attendance, monthly payments and automated reminders.
- Student portal at /mi-pilates: students log in and book a class, a week or a month within their plan; installable as a lightweight PWA. Class prices managed in the plugin appear on the Elementor site through a custom dynamic tag.
- Medical data encrypted at rest with libsodium; a restricted role lets the instructor see it without WordPress admin rights. Forms protected with nonces and capability checks; queries prepared and output escaped.
- Release pipeline: GitHub Actions publishes staging and stable channels, a private updater delivers new versions inside wp-admin, and a pre-release check runs PHP lint and regression tests.
- Migrated tatipilates.com and bhoga.yoga from SiteGround to an Amazon Lightsail server I set up and run: Ubuntu 24.04, Nginx, PHP 8.3-FPM and MariaDB, each site isolated with its own Linux user, PHP pool, database and logs.
- Replaced hosting plugins with server-level work: Nginx FastCGI page cache with bypass rules, gzip and static caching, security headers, PHP blocked in uploads, fail2ban on SSH and wp-login, key-only SSH and unattended upgrades.
- Route 53 DNS (IPv4 and IPv6), Let’s Encrypt auto-renewal, transactional email through Amazon SES with DKIM and DMARC, daily snapshots with a tested restore, uptime monitoring and AWS Budgets alerts.
- Local SEO with Rank Math and Yoast (local business and FAQ structured data, per-city titles): the sites appear on Google and in its AI summaries for searches such as “pilates Punto Fijo” and “yoga en San Carlos del Zulia”.

**Shopify Developer, Trafilea Group**

December 2019 to June 2026 | Argentina (Remote)

- Built high-conversion Shopify stores for international DTC brands.
- Ran A/B tests that increased Facebook ad ROAS by 15%.
- Delivered mobile-first campaigns under tight deadlines, improving UX and page speed.
- Reduced load times by an average of 35% through Core Web Vitals optimization.

**Shopify Developer, Redstage**

August 2016 to August 2019 | Argentina

- Built scalable custom themes and optimized site architecture for high-traffic ecommerce.
- Developed a custom internal CRM system that improved operational efficiency.
- Partnered with marketing and product teams to ensure smooth project launches.

## EDUCATION

Universidad de los Andes (Venezuela): Systems Engineering, 2010 to 2016

## CERTIFICATIONS AND LANGUAGES

EF SET English Certificate: C1 Advanced (CEFR) · JavaScript Fundamentals, Coddy
Spanish (native), English (C1 Advanced)